

Reference: 1-274894363

18 December 2014

Peter Eckersley
By email to: request-238892-692e5e2d@whatdotheyknow.com

Information Requests
Secretariat

information.requests@ofcom.org.uk

Freedom of Information: Right to know request

Dear Mr Eckersley

Thank you for your request for information about 'Callsigns assigned outside of sequential order', which Ofcom received on 12 November and has considered under the Freedom of Information Act 2000 (the Act).

You asked:

"Could you please provide the numbers, in each calendar year, of callsigns issued other than in strict sequential order (e.g. re-issuing of previously-issued callsigns to the original holder, re-issuing of previously-issued callsigns on the request of a family member of a deceased holder).

Please state for each of the last 10 years, and state the reasons for issuing callsigns other than in the expected alphanumeric sequence."

Firstly, I would like to apologise for our delay in responding to you.

We have searched for the information you requested. However, the information is not readily accessible, as a considerable amount of time would be needed to locate, retrieve, identify and extract any relevant information. Our current database went live in 2007 and all licences were re-issued at this point in a new format.

Section 12 of the Freedom of Information Act 2000 provides that a public authority is not obliged to comply with a request for information if the authority estimates that the cost of complying with the request would exceed the "appropriate limit".

The appropriate limit is set out in the Freedom of Information and Data Protection (Appropriate Limit and Fees) Regulations 2004, and is, for Ofcom, £450. That sum is intended to cover the estimated costs involved in determining whether Ofcom holds the information requested, identifying, locating, retrieving and extracting the information from any document containing it. The Regulations provide that costs are to be estimated at a rate of £25 per person per hour.

Ofcom estimates that it would take more than 18 hours to identify, locate and extract the information you require and as such the cost of complying with your request will exceed the appropriate limit. We will therefore not be able to provide any information in connection to your request.

More information on this section of the Act can be found here:

<http://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/2000/36/section/12>.

If you wish to submit an alternative request with a narrower, more specific scope in relation to this subject, we would be happy to give it our full consideration. In any event, with any information requested, exemptions may apply.

If you have any queries about this letter, please contact me. Please remember to quote the reference number above in any future communications.

Yours sincerely,

Jenny Borritt

If you are unhappy with the response or level of service you have received in relation to your request from Ofcom, you may ask for an internal review. If you ask us for an internal review of our decision, it will be treated as a formal complaint and will be subject to an independent review within Ofcom. We will acknowledge the complaint and inform you of the date by which you might expect to be told the outcome.

The following outcomes are possible:

- the original decision is upheld; or
- the original decision is reversed or modified.

Timing

If you wish to exercise your right to an internal review **you should contact us within two months of the date of this letter**. There is no statutory deadline for undertaking internal reviews and it will depend upon the complexity of the case. However, we aim to conclude all such reviews within 20 working days, and up to 40 working days in exception cases. We will keep you informed of the progress of any such review. If you wish to request an internal review, you should contact:

Graham Howell
The Secretary to the Corporation
Ofcom
Riverside House
2a Southwark Bridge Road
London SE1 9HA

If you are not content with the outcome of the internal review, you have the right to apply directly to the Information Commissioner for a decision. The Information Commissioner can be contacted at:

Information Commissioner's Office
Wycliffe House
Water Lane
Wilmslow
Cheshire
SK9 5AF